

TSC PROVINCIAL MATTERS ADMINISTRATION MANUAL (PROFESSIONAL ASSISTANT)

ADMINISTRATIVE SYSTEM:

1. CASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Teacher matter must have a reference number

- PM= Provincial Matters
- NCD =Province
- 2026 = years
- 00001 = sequential case number

Case register should contain:

Field	Information
Case No.	PM/NCD/2026/00001
Date Received	28/08/2026
Teacher:	Name/Employee reference
Matter	Appointment/Industrial/legal
Officer	Assigned Officer
Section referred	Appointment/Industrial/Legal
Date referred	Date
Status	Pending / In progress/Resolved
Action required	Description
Due Date	Date
Outcome	Decision /Advise
Date closed	Date

TO HELP THE DIRECTOR MONITOR CASES, USE STANDARD STATUS CODES

. NEW- newly received

-VER- Verification required

INV- Investigation in progress

REF – referred to National Section (HQ)

ADV – awaiting advise

DEC- awaiting decision

LEG – With legal Section

ACT- action being implemented

RES: resolved

CLS – Closed

ESC – due to delay



TEACHING SERVICE COMMISSION

"Teachers Build Our Nation"

TSC PROVINCIAL MATTERS ADMINISTRATION MANUAL

Provincial Matters Division

Administrative and Operational Guidelines

Status: Working Draft

Purpose: Internal administrative and operational guidance

1. Purpose of the Manual

The purpose of this Manual is to provide a clear administrative framework for the management of teachers' matters at the provincial level.

It is intended to:

- ✓ Provide consistent procedures for receiving and processing teachers' matters
- ✓ Define the responsibilities of Provincial Matters officers
- ✓ Establish clear referral procedures between Provincial and National TSC Sections.
- ✓ Ensure matters are properly recorded, tracked and followed up
- ✓ Prevent unnecessary delays in resolving teacher's matters
- ✓ Provide accountability for officers handling cases
- ✓ Establish a clear escalation process for matters that cannot be resolved at provincial level
- ✓ Ensure matters requiring legal advice are properly referred to the Legal Section
- ✓ Assist the Director, Provincial Matters, to monitor provincial performance and outstanding cases.

The Manual should operate together with the Teaching Service Act, applicable regulations, TSC policies, determinations, circulars, approved delegations and other relevant government instruments

2. Administration Principal

The Provincial Matters Division should operate on the following principle:

Provincial matters is the first-level service delivery, coordination and case management arm of the Commission for teachers matters, operating within delegated authority and referring matters requiring specialized or higher-level determination to the appropriate National TSC Section.

3. Relationship with National TSC Sections

Provincial Matters should maintain a structured working relationship with the National Section

Matter	Primary technical authority
Appointment/Selection/tenure	Appointments
Salary/allowance/condition of service	Industrial and General
Legal interpretation/legal proceedings	Legal
Policy interpretation	Relevant Policy/Mangement authority
Teacher records/data	Relevant records/HR functions(ICT)
Provincial service delivery	Provincial Matters

The Provincial Matters officer acts as the link between the teacher/province and the relevant National Section.

4. ROLES OF PROVINCIAL MATTER OFFICERS

Provincial officers should be responsible for:

Receiving matters

- Receive teacher applications, complaints, queries and requests
- Check that application are properly completed
- Confirm supporting documents
- Register each matter

Assessment

- Identify the nature of the matter
- Determine whether it falls within provincial delegated authority
- Identify whether another TSC Section must be consulted

Investigation

Where appropriate:

- Check teacher records
- Obtain information from the school
- Verify appointment and employment information
- Obtain relevant supporting documents
- Record finding objectively

Resolution

Where authorized:

- Resolve the matter
- Provide the teacher with the appropriate response
- Record the decision
- Close the case

Referral

Where the matter is outside provincial authority:

- Prepare a referral
- Attach the complete case file
- Identify the specific issue requiring consideration
- Refer it to the correct National Section
- Follow up until an outcome is received

5. MATTERS THAT SHOULD BE REFERRED

A Provincial officer should refer a matter when:

- It is outside the officers delegated authority
- It requires a decision by the Commission
- It involves interpretation of legislation
- It involves a dispute over a statutory entitlement
- It involves a formal appointment appeal
- It involves a significant industrial dispute
- It involves threatened or actual court proceedings
- A Lawyer's letter has been served
- The matter involves judicial review
- There is uncertainty about the applicable law or policy
- The matter has potential financial or legal implications for the Commission

6. LEGAL REFERRAL PROCEDURE

Legal matters should receive priority treatment

Procedure

Teacher/Province - Provincial Matters Officer – Register matter – Identify legal issue – Notify Director Provincial Matters- Refer to Legal Section – Legal Assessment/Advise – Commission/authorized officer makes required decision – Provincial Matters communicates/implements outcome - Close and archive file

Important rule

Provincial Officers should not provide their own legal opinions.

They may explain approved TSC policies and procedures, but questions concerning the legal meaning or application of legislation should be referred to the Legal Section.

7. Appointment Matters

Provincial Matters should act as the frontline processing and coordination point while the Appointment Section retains responsibility for matters reserved to it.

Provincial officers may:

- Receive appointment related queries
- Verify documents

- Check appointment records
- Obtain information from school/provinces
- Identify missing documentation
- Prepare referrals
- Follow up with Appointments
- Communication approved outcomes

Where the matter concerns a formal appointment decision or appeal outside provincial delegation, it should be referred to Appointments

8. Industrial and General Matters

Provincial Officers may receive and investigate routine matters involving:

- Salary
- Allowances
- Leave
- Condition of service
- Resignation
- Retirement
- Other employment entitlements

The provincial office should first verify the teachers record and supporting documents.

If the matter cannot be resolved under provincial delegation, it should be referred to Industrial & General with a clear statement of:

What the teacher is claiming + what the province verified + what remains unresolved + what decision/advise is required.

9. Case Management System

Every teacher matter should have a unique reference number:

For example

PM/NCD/2026/0001

Where:

PM = Provincial Matters

NCD= Province

2026 = year

0001 = Sequential case number

The Case number should contain:

FIELD	INFORMATION
Case No.	PM/NCD/2026/0001
Date received	28/08/2026
Province	NCD
Teacher	Name/Employee reference
Matter	Appointment/Industrial/Legal/etc.
Officer	Assigned officer

Section referred	Appointment/Industrial/Legal
Date referred	date
Status	Pending /In progress/Resolved
Action required	Description
Due Date	date
Outcome	Decision/advice
Date closed	Date

10. Case status categories

To help the Director monitor cases use standard status codes;

- NEW – newly received
- VER – verification required
- INV – investigation in progress
- REF – referred to National Section (HQ)
- ADV – awaiting advice
- DEC – awaiting decision
- LEG – with Legal Section
- ACT – action being implemented
- RES – resolved
- CLS – closed
- ESC – escalated due to delay

This makes monthly reporting much easier.

11. FILE MANAGEMENT

Each matter should have a complete case file containing:

- Original application/query
- Supporting documents
- Correspondence received
- Correspondence sent
- Investigations notes
- Relevant records
- Referral Letters
- Advice received
- Decisions
- Evidence of communication to the teacher
- Closure record

No important decision should exist only through verbal communication.

Where important an instruction is given verbally, it should be confirmed in writing and place on file.

12. Role of the Professional Assistant to the Director

This is where my position becomes particularly important.

My role can be structured around five functions;

A. Office coordination

I assist the Director with:

- Incoming correspondence
- Outgoing correspondence
- Meetings
- Briefings
- Provincial Reports
- Follow up action
- Submission of Files

B. Case Monitoring

I maintain the central register and identify

- New matters
- Outstanding matters
- Delay matters
- Legal matters
- Matters awaiting National Section responses
- Matters requiring Directors attention

C. Briefing Director

Before presenting a matter to the Director, prepare a short case report:

Issue: What is the problem

Background: What happen

Action taken: What has already been done.

Current position: where is the matter now?

Issue requiring decision: what does the Director need to decide

Recommendation: What action is opposed

This can save Director significant time.

D. Follow-up

If the matter is referred to Appointments, Industrial and General or Legal, you monitor the response.

Example:

“ Referred to Legal on 10 September – advice outstanding

You should then follow-up accordingly to the approval timeframe

E. Reporting

Prepare the Directors:

- Weekly outstanding matters list
- Monthly provincial report
- Quarterly performance report

- Urgent/legal matters report
- Matters requiring Commission attention

13. Director's Weekly Brief

Preparing a one-page weekly brief

Period _____

A. Urgent matters

1. Case No. Province – Issue- Action required

B. Legal Matters

1. Case No, Status – Legal Section action required

C. Appointment

- New:
- Pending:
- Resolved

D. Industrial & General

- New:
- Pending
- Resolved:

E. Overdue Matters

Case _____ - _____ days outstanding

Case _____ - _____ days outstanding

F. Decisions required from Director

- 1.
- 2.

This is very effective administrative tool

14. Escalation System

A matter should not remain indefinitely with an officer.

A simple escalation structure is:

Officer;



Senior/Regional officer



Director, Provincial Matters



Relevant National Section



Commissioner/Management

► Commission, where required
▼

Legal Section, where legal issues arise

The actual levels should be aligned with approved TSC delegation instruments.

15. Accountability

Every office handling a matter should be identifiable

The case register should show:

Who received it → who processed it → who referred it → who made the decision – who communicated the outcome

This creates accountability and helps prevent cases from being lost between offices

16. **Proposed Delegation Principle**

I strongly recommend that TSC develop a separate Delegation of Authority Schedule for Provincial Matters

It should specify:

What Provincial Officers CAN decide

And

What Provincial Officers CAN recommend but cannot decide

And What must be referred to National Section

And

What must be referred to the Commission

Without this, Provincial officers may either overstep their authority or alternatively refer everything to Port Moresby and create unnecessary delays.

17. **THE GOLDEN RULE FOR PROVINCIAL ADMINISTRATION**

“No teacher matter should be received without being registered, no registered matter should remain without an assigned action, no referred matter should remain without follow up and no matter should be closed without a recorded outcome”

This single principle can greatly improve administration

18. **WHAT I RECOMMEND TO BUILD NEXT**

As a Professional Assistant to Director, Provincial Matters I would build my administrative system in this order:

1. Provincial Matters Administration Manuel
2. Delegation of Authority Matrix
3. Teacher Matters Case Register
4. Teacher Matters Referral Form
5. Legal Referral Form
6. Case brief template for the Director
7. Weekly outstanding Matters Report
8. Monthly Provincial Matters Report
9. Provincial Officer Performance Report
10. Standard Operating Procedures (SOPS)

The most important document after the Manuel is the Delegation of Authority Matrix because it will answer the practical question you raised earlier: when a Provincial Officer should act, when to refer to appointments or industrial and General and when to refer directly to Legal or the Commission.

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